

GRIEVANCE MECHANISM AND DISCIPLINARY POLICY

1. Purpose

EmpireOne BPO Solutions is committed to maintaining a professional, respectful, and fair workplace. This policy establishes:

- A formal grievance mechanism for employees to raise workplace concerns; and
- A structured disciplinary process for addressing violations of the Code of Conduct and Discipline (COCD)

This policy ensures that all actions are carried out in accordance with due process, fairness, and the Labor Code of the Philippines.

2. Coverage

This policy applies to all employees, including:

- Probationary employees
- Regular employees
- Project-based employees
- Contractual employees

3. Grievance Policy Statement

Employees are encouraged to raise concerns in good faith without fear of retaliation. The Company shall ensure that all grievances are handled:

- Promptly
- Objectively
- Confidentially

Grievances may include, but are not limited to:

- Workplace conflicts or disputes
- Concerns on management actions or decisions
- Work conditions or treatment
- Alleged violations of company policies

GRIEVANCE MECHANISM AND DISCIPLINARY POLICY

4. Grievance Reporting Procedure

Employees may raise concerns through the following channels:

4.1 Immediate Supervisor

The employee should initially raise the concern with their immediate supervisor for resolution.

4.2 Department Manager

If the concern is not resolved, the employee may escalate the matter to the Department Manager.

4.3 Human Resources Department

Employees may directly report concerns to the Human Resources Department, especially when:

- The concern involves their immediate supervisor; or
- The employee is not comfortable raising the concern within the team

The HR Department shall:

- Conduct fact-finding
- Facilitate mediation, when appropriate
- Recommend appropriate action or resolution

5. Non-Retaliation Policy

The Company strictly prohibits retaliation against employees who raise concerns in good faith.

Any act of retaliation shall be treated as a serious violation and subject to disciplinary action.

6. Confidentiality of Grievances

All grievance reports shall be treated with strict confidentiality. Information shall only be disclosed on a need-to-know basis to properly address the concern.

GRIEVANCE MECHANISM AND DISCIPLINARY POLICY

7. Code of Conduct and Discipline (COCD)

All employees are required to comply with the Company's Code of Conduct and Discipline (COCD).

Violations shall be classified based on their nature and severity, and corresponding disciplinary actions shall be imposed accordingly.

8. Disciplinary Principles

The Company shall observe the following principles in all disciplinary actions:

- Due Process
- Progressive Discipline, where applicable
- Proportionality of Penalty
- Consistency and Fairness

9. Disciplinary Procedure (Twin Notice Rule)

The following procedure shall be observed:

Step 1: Incident Report or Complaint

Any violation may be reported by:

- Supervisor or manager
- Co-employee
- Client (for BPO operations)

All incidents shall be properly documented and endorsed to Human Resources.

Step 2: Notice to Explain (NTE)

The employee shall be issued a **Notice to Explain (NTE)** containing:

- Specific details of the alleged violation
- Relevant facts and circumstances

The employee shall be given at least **five (5) calendar days** to submit a written explanation.

GRIEVANCE MECHANISM AND DISCIPLINARY POLICY

Step 3: Administrative Hearing or Conference

An administrative hearing or conference may be conducted:

- To clarify facts
- To allow the employee to present evidence and witnesses

The employee may be assisted by a representative, if desired.

Step 4: Evaluation of Evidence

The Human Resources Department, in coordination with management, shall evaluate:

- Incident reports
- Employee explanation
- Evidence and findings

Step 5: Notice of Decision (NOD)

A **Notice of Decision** shall be issued indicating:

- Findings of the investigation
- Final disciplinary action, if any
- Effectivity of the penalty

10. Disciplinary Actions

Depending on the severity of the violation, disciplinary actions may include:

- Verbal Warning
- Written Warning
- Final Written Warning
- Suspension
- Termination of Employment

The Company reserves the right to impose **immediate termination** for serious offenses in accordance with the Labor Code and COCD.

GRIEVANCE MECHANISM AND DISCIPLINARY POLICY

11. Client and Operational Considerations

In a BPO environment, disciplinary actions may also arise from:

- Client-reported incidents
- Failure to meet client compliance requirements
- Breach of data security or confidentiality

Client-imposed sanctions or non-endorsement may be considered in the disciplinary process, subject to due process.

12. Preventive Suspension

The Company may place an employee under preventive suspension when:

- The employee's continued presence poses a serious and imminent threat to the Company, employees, or clients

Preventive suspension shall not exceed **thirty (30) days**, unless extended in accordance with law.

13. Record-Keeping and Documentation

All disciplinary actions shall be:

- Properly documented
- Maintained in the employee's 201 file

These records may be used for performance evaluation and future disciplinary considerations.

POLICY REVIEW

This policy will continue to be in force unless superseded by a revised policy. The company reserves the right to amend, abrogate, modify, rescind/ reinstate the entire policy or any part of it at any time.

GRIEVANCE MECHANISM AND DISCIPLINARY POLICY

DOCUMENT HISTORY

Version	Date	Author (function)	Reviewed by	Approved by	Nature of changes
1.0	March 18, 2026	Dolley Campugan, HR Generalist Apple Mag-usara, HR Generalist	Rhea Alao, Finance & Accounting Director Christi Ann Sanchez, Talent Acquisition Manager Mark Valencia, Site Director Marc Louise Castanares, Site Manager	Giovanni Yap, Executive Director Anthony Aragon, HR Director	First Integrated issue